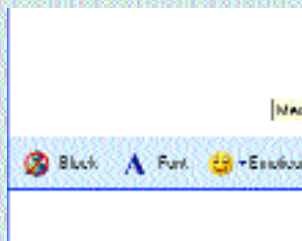


contents including mail, contacts, notes and reminders are stored.

These phone calls to regional offices are costing us so much!

Instant Messenger (IM) services such as Yahoo!, MSN, etc provide very good functions for text, voice and file transfers—you only need to be connected to the Internet. Apart from pro-

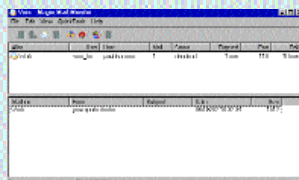


Cost-effective communication with IMs

viding a cost-effective alternative for communication, IMs are also convenient. For example, you can leave messages for a person even while he or she is not at the desk and transfer files directly, thus avoiding large e-mail attachments.

How can I preview e-mail and download only the relevant ones?

There are various freeware and shareware tools available that allow you to preview e-mail before downloading them from the server, even from POP3 servers. You can see the sender, recipients, subject and time stamps—these are usually enough to determine whether the message



Preview e-mail before downloading

is important or not. Magic Mail Monitor (www.geocities.com/SiliconValley/Vista/2576/magic.html) is a free tool that can handle multiple e-mail accounts and check them at regular intervals. It sits in the system tray and can optionally display the entire message, too. From here itself, you can reply, send or delete the e-mail.

If your server supports it, you can use IMAP for the same functionality. By default, Outlook and Outlook Express download only headers for IMAP folders. You can preview each message, download the ones you want and delete the rest. You can use IMAP just for preview and have the same account configured for

POP3, so after previewing and deleting messages, the ones you need can be downloaded to your desktop.

Sometimes when I shutdown Windows, I get a message that someone's connected to my PC, but I have nothing shared. How do I make sure no one's hacking into my data?

If you have Windows 9x, you can check who's connected to your computer using the Net Watcher tool. To install it, open **Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs > Windows Setup**. Select **System Tools** and click **Details**. Check the box for **Net Watcher** and click **OK**. You can launch the program from **Start > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Net Watcher**. It will display all open connections, shared folders and open files. If you want, you can also disconnect users from here.

For Windows 2000 and XP, right-click on **My Computer** and click **Manage**. This

will open the Microsoft Management Console (MMC) for Computer Management. Expand the **Shared Folders** item. Under **'Shares'**, you can see what folders are shared. **'Sessions'** will show currently connected users and **'Open Files'** displays files opened over the network. You can disconnect users or close open files.

These agreement documents are huge. It takes me so much time to go through them and most of it is fluff anyway.

Word uses a powerful feature called **Outlines** for organising information. It takes just a slight extra effort and dili-



Organising information with styles

gence on your part when creating a document to organise the information correctly. Use **Styles** to mark out headings and subheadings in the document, in the hierarchy in which they are supposed to be (Heading1 corresponds to the first level, Heading2 to the second, and so on). Don't use or not use certain styles just because the font doesn't look good—you can change the appearance from **Format > Styles**.

If your document is created correctly, you can use

